Himaayah Schools

Ages 4–8

HIMAAYAH CHILDREN'S LEARNING SERIES

My First Arabic Letters



Look. Say. Trace. Write.

A picture-and-tracing book for learning the 28 letters of the Arabic alphabet

28 letters · sounds and words · letter shapes · tracing · short vowels · certificate

WELCOME

Assalāmu ʿalaykum, little reader!

This is **your** book for learning the letters of the Arabic language. Arabic is the language of the Qur'an. When you know the letters, you can learn to read the words of Allah.

How to use this book

- Do **one or two letters** a day. Go slowly.
- Look at the big letter. **Say its name** with your grown-up.
- Say the word. Look at the picture in your mind.
- Trace the grey letters with a pencil. Then write your own.
- Ask your teacher or parent to say each sound. Sounds are best learnt **by listening**.

A note for parents and teachers

Arabic is read from **right to left**. The sound guides in this book are only hints. Some Arabic sounds do not exist in English, so please let your child hear the real sound from a teacher who recites well.

Learn two letters a day for two weeks, and use the last pages to revise. Short, happy sessions of 10 to 15 minutes work best.

Remember: read this way



Arabic starts on the **right** and moves to the **left**.

THE ALPHABET

The 28 letters at a glance

Point to each letter and say its name. Which ones do you already know?

ا	ب	ت	ث	ج	ح	خ
alif	bāʾ	tāʾ	thāʾ	jīm	ḥāʾ	khāʾ
د	ذ	ر	ز	س	ش	ص
dāl	dhāl	rāʾ	zāy	sīn	shīn	ṣād
ض	ط	ظ	ع	غ	ف	ق
ḍād	ṭāʾ	ẓāʾ	ʿayn	ghayn	fāʾ	qāf
ك	ل	م	ن	ه	و	ي
kāf	lām	mīm	nūn	hāʾ	wāw	yāʾ

There is also **hamzah** (ء), a small catch in the throat, which you will meet with a teacher. Words use it in places like ماء (māʾ, water).

Letters that do not join forward

Six letters never join to the letter after them: ا د ذ ر ز و. After these, the next letter starts fresh. You will see this in the pages ahead.

ا

Letter 1 of 28

alif

Sound: a long “aa”, like the a in “father”

Example word

أَسَد

asad: lion

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ا	ا	ا	ـا

Now you write:

ب

Letter 2 of 28

bāʾ

Sound: “b” as in ball

Example word

بَطَّة

baṭṭah: duck

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ب	بـ	ـبـ	ـب

Now you write:

ت

Letter 3 of 28

tāʾ

Sound: “t” as in table

Example word

تُفَّاح

tuffāḥ: apples

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ت	تـ	ـتـ	ـت

ت ت ت ت ت ت

Now you write:

ث

Letter 4 of 28

thāʾ

Sound: “th” as in think

Example word

ثَعْلَب

thaʿlab: fox

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ث	ثـ	ـثـ	ـث

ث ث ث ث ث ث

Now you write:

ج

Letter 5 of 28

jīm

Sound: “j” as in jam

Example word

جَمَل

jamal: camel

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ج	جـ	ـجـ	ـج

ج ج ج ج ج ج

Now you write:

ح

Letter 6 of 28

ḥāʾ

Sound: a soft, breathy “h” from the middle of the throat

Example word

حِصَان

ḥiṣān: horse

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ح	حـ	ـحـ	ـح

ح ح ح ح ح ح

Now you write:

خ

Letter 7 of 28

khāʾ

Sound: like the “ch” in the Scottish word “loch”

Example word

خُبْز

khubz: bread

Alone	Start	Middle	End
خ	خ	خ	خ

خ خ خ خ خ خ

Now you write:

د

Letter 8 of 28

dāl

Sound: “d” as in door

Example word

دَجَاجَة

dajājah: hen

Alone	Start	Middle	End
د	د	د	د

د د د د د د

Now you write:

ذ

Letter 9 of 28

dhāl

Sound: “th” as in this

Example word

ذُرَة

dhurah: corn

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ذ	ذ	ذ	ذ

ذ ذ ذ ذ ذ ذ

Now you write:

ر

Letter 10 of 28

rāʾ

Sound: “r”, rolled lightly

Example word

رُمَّان

rummān: pomegranate

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ر	ر	ر	ر

ر ر ر ر ر ر

Now you write:

ز

Letter 11 of 28

zāy

Sound: “z” as in zebra

Example word

زَرَافَة

zarāfah: giraffe

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ز	ز	ز	ز

ز ز ز ز ز ز

Now you write:

س

Letter 12 of 28

sīn

Sound: “s” as in sun

Example word

سَمَكَة

samakah: fish

Alone	Start	Middle	End
س	سـ	ـسـ	ـس

س س س س س س

Now you write:

ش

Letter 13 of 28

shīn

Sound: “sh” as in ship

Example word

شَمْس

shams: sun

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ش	شـ	ـشـ	ـش

ش ش ش ش ش ش ش

Now you write:

ص

Letter 14 of 28

ṣād

Sound: a heavy, full “s”

Example word

صَقْر

ṣaqr: falcon

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ص	صـ	ـصـ	ـص

ص ص ص ص ص ص ص

Now you write:

ض

Letter 15 of 28

ḍād

Sound: a heavy, full “d”

Example word

ضِفْدَع

ḍifdaʿ: frog

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ض	ضـ	ـضـ	ـض

ض ض ض ض ض ض

Now you write:

ط

Letter 16 of 28

ṭāʾ

Sound: a heavy, full “t”

Example word

طَائِر

ṭāʾir: bird

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ط	طـ	ـطـ	ـط

ط ط ط ط ط ط

Now you write:

ظ

Letter 17 of 28

ẓāʾ

Sound: a heavy “th”, as in this, but full

Example word

ظَرْف

ẓarf: envelope

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ظ	ظ	ظ	ظ

ظ ظ ظ ظ ظ ظ

Now you write:

ع

Letter 18 of 28

ʿayn

Sound: a deep sound made in the throat

Example word

عَيْن

ʿayn: eye

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ع	عـ	ـعـ	ـع

ع ع ع ع ع ع

Now you write:

غ

Letter 19 of 28

ghayn

Sound: like a soft gargle in the throat

Example word

غَيْمَة

ghaymah: cloud

Alone	Start	Middle	End
غ	غـ	ـغـ	ـغ

غ غ غ غ غ غ

Now you write:

ف

Letter 20 of 28

fā’

Sound: “f” as in fish

Example word

فِيل

fīl: elephant

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ف	فـ	ـفـ	ـف

ف ف ف ف ف ف

Now you write:

ق

Letter 21 of 28

qāf

Sound: a deep “k” from the back of the throat

Example word

قَمَر

qamar: moon

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ق	قـ	ـقـ	ـق

ق ق ق ق ق ق

Now you write:

ك

Letter 22 of 28

kāf

Sound: “k” as in kite

Example word

كِتَاب

kitāb: book

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ك	كـ	ـكـ	ـك

ك ك ك ك ك ك

Now you write:

ل

Letter 23 of 28

lām

Sound: “l” as in lemon

Example word

لَيْمُون

laymūn: lemon

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ل	لـ	ـلـ	ـل

ل ل ل ل ل ل

Now you write:

م

Letter 24 of 28

mīm

Sound: “m” as in moon

Example word

مَاء

mā’: water

Alone	Start	Middle	End
م	مـ	ـمـ	ـم

م م م م م م

Now you write:

ن

Letter 25 of 28

nūn

Sound: “n” as in nose

Example word

نَخْلَة

nakhlah: palm tree

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ن	نـ	ـنـ	ـن

ن ن ن ن ن ن

Now you write:

ه

Letter 26 of 28

hāʾ

Sound: “h” as in hat, breathed out

Example word

هِلَال

hilāl: crescent moon

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ه	هـ	ـهـ	ـه

ه ه ه ه ه ه

Now you write:

و

Letter 27 of 28

wāw

Sound: “w” as in water (or a long “oo”)

Example word

وَرْدَة

wardah: rose

Alone	Start	Middle	End
و	و	و	ـو

و و و و و و

Now you write:

ي

Letter 28 of 28

yāʾ

Sound: “y” as in yes (or a long “ee”)

Example word

يَد

yad: hand

Alone	Start	Middle	End
ي	يـ	ـيـ	ـي

ي ي ي ي ي ي

Now you write:

SHORT VOWELS

Three little marks that make sounds

Small marks above or below a letter tell us **which sound** to say. Let us learn them with the letter ب (b).

بَ	بِ	بُ
fatḥah	**kasrah**	**ḍammah**
“ba”	“bi”	“bu”
A small line above	A small line below	A small curl above

Say these out loud with your grown-up. Point to each one as you say it.

Letter “b”	بَ ba	بِ bi	بُ bu
Letter “t”	تَ ta	تِ ti	تُ tu
Letter “m”	مَ ma	مِ mi	مُ mu
Letter “n”	نَ na	نِ ni	نُ nu

Two more marks to look for

Sukūn (ْ) a little circle: the letter has no vowel. Example: بَابْ

Shaddah (ّ) a little “w”: say the letter twice. Example: رَبَّ

READ

My first Arabic words

Read each word from right to left. Then match it with its meaning by drawing a line.

بَاب bāb	house
كَلْب kalb	pen
قَلَم qalam	sun
بَيْت bayt	dog
شَمْس shams	door
مَاء māʾ	water

Find the letter

Circle the letter ب in each word. How many can you find?

بَابٌ　　كِتَابٌ　　بَطَّةٌ　　بَيْتٌ

MORE PRACTICE

First letter, last letter

First letter

Write the first letter of each word.

قَمَر First letter: ____	فِيل First letter: ____	جَمَل First letter: ____	نَخْلَة First letter: ____

Last letter

Write the last letter of each word.

كِتَاب Last letter: ____	بَيْت Last letter: ____	شَمْس Last letter: ____	قَلَم Last letter: ____

Copy the words

بَيْت	Write it here:
قَمَر	Write it here:
شَمْس	Write it here:

LETTERS THAT LOOK ALIKE

It is all in the dots

Many Arabic letters have the **same shape**. The **dots** tell them apart: how many, and whether they are **above or below**.

ب ت ث	**bāʾ tāʾ thāʾ**	One dot below, two above, three above
ج ح خ	**jīm ḥāʾ khāʾ**	One dot below, none, one above
د ذ	**dāl dhāl**	None, one above
ر ز	**rāʾ zāy**	None, one above
س ش	**sīn shīn**	None, three above
ص ض	**ṣād ḍād**	None, one above
ع غ	**ʿayn ghayn**	None, one above
ف ق	**fāʾ qāf**	One above, two above

Count the dots

ب	ت	ث	ج	ش	ي
dots: ___	dots: ___	dots: ___	dots: ___	dots: ___	dots: ___

(Answers: 1, 2, 3, 1, 3, 2.)

LONG VOWELS

Making the sound longer

Three letters can make a vowel **long**. Hold the sound for two counts.

بَا	بِي	بُو
alif after a fatḥah “baa”	**yāʾ after a kasrah** “bee”	**wāw after a ḍammah** “boo”

Read these words. The long vowel is in the middle.

بَاب	**bāb**	door
كِتَاب	**kitāb**	book
نُور	**nūr**	light
فِيل	**fīl**	elephant
دِين	**dīn**	religion
قَارِب	**qārib**	boat

Read and tick

بَا بِي بُو	☐ Yes
تَا تِي تُو	☐ Yes
مَا مِي مُو	☐ Yes

DOUBLE MARKS

Little sounds at the end of words

When a **double mark** sits on the last letter of a word, we add an **n** sound: **an**, **in** or **un**. This is called **tanwīn**.

بً	بٍ	بٌ
two fatḥahs “ban”	**two kasrahs** “bin”	**two ḍammahs** “bun”

كِتَابٌ	**kitābun**	a book
بَيْتٌ	**baytun**	a house
قَلَمٌ	**qalamun**	a pen
وَلَدٌ	**waladun**	a boy
بِنْتٌ	**bintun**	a girl

Say each word out loud. Your teacher will show you the other two sounds too.

Draw one of the things from this page, and write its name in Arabic beside it

NUMBERS

Counting in Arabic

Arabic has its own number shapes. Say each one with your grown-up.

١	واحد	wāḥid	1
٢	اثنان	ithnān	2
٣	ثلاثة	thalāthah	3
٤	أربعة	arbaʿah	4
٥	خمسة	khamsah	5
٦	ستة	sittah	6
٧	سبعة	sabʿah	7
٨	ثمانية	thamāniyah	8
٩	تسعة	tisʿah	9
١٠	عشرة	ʿasharah	10

Write the numbers

Number	Write it in Arabic
3	
5	
8	
10	

COLOURS

Colours in Arabic

Read each word. Then colour the box with the right colour.

أَحْمَر **aḥmar** red	أَزْرَق **azraq** blue	أَخْضَر **akhḍar** green
أَصْفَر **aṣfar** yellow	أَبْيَض **abyaḍ** white	أَسْوَد **aswad** black

Colour it in

أَحْمَر

أَخْضَر

أَزْرَق

Draw one thing for each colour, and colour it.

READ THE QUR'AN

Bismillāh, word by word

Now you can read the first words that start almost every sūrah of the Qur'an! Read each word slowly.

1	بِسْمِ *Bismi*	In the name of
2	ٱللَّهِ *Allāhi*	Allah
3	ٱلرَّحْمَٰنِ *ar-Raḥmāni*	the Most Kind
4	ٱلرَّحِيمِ *ar-Raḥīmi*	the Most Merciful

بِسْمِ ٱللَّهِ ٱلرَّحْمَٰنِ ٱلرَّحِيمِ

In the name of Allah, the Most Kind, the Most Merciful.

Said at the start of everything good

Words I can read from the Qur'an

رَبّ	**rabb**	Lord
نُور	**nūr**	light
كِتَاب	**kitāb**	book
قُرْآن	**qurʾān**	recitation, the Qur'an

FAMILY

Words for my family

Read the words for the people we love. Then draw your family.

أُمّ	**umm**	mother
أَب	**ab**	father
أَخ	**akh**	brother
أُخْت	**ukht**	sister
جَدّ	**jadd**	grandfather
جَدَّة	**jaddah**	grandmother

Draw your family, and write the Arabic words beside each person

MY NAME

Look and write

Ask your teacher to write your name in Arabic. Then copy it here, and decorate it.

My name in Arabic

Draw **three** things from this book whose names start with letters you know.

Picture 1

Picture 2

Picture 3

Alḥamdulillāh!

You have met all 28 letters of the Arabic alphabet. Keep practising a little every day, and soon you will be reading the words of the Qur'an, in shā' Allāh.

رَبِّ زِدْنِي عِلْمًا

"My Lord, increase me in knowledge." (Ṭā Hā 20:114)

CERTIFICATE

I know my Arabic letters!

Name: _____

Date: _____ *Teacher or parent:* _____

Every great reader starts with one letter.

My First Arabic Letters teaches the 28 letters of the Arabic alphabet slowly and joyfully, with big letters, picture words, letter shapes and tracing practice. It prepares children to read the Qur'an with a teacher, in shā' Allāh.

- All 28 letters with sound guides
- An example word for every letter
- Letter shapes at the start, middle and end
- Tracing practice and short vowels
- Games, a certificate and notes for parents